

A Guide To Managing
Food Allergies
—— at ——
New York University

New York University
60 Washington Square South
New York, New York 10012

Campus Registered Dietitian
nyu.eats.nutrition@nyu.edu

For more information about our process for
managing allergies, including menus, visit
NYU Eats online at nyueats.com.

Table of Contents

From Us To You	4
Our Philosophy	5
How To Self-Identify	6
Your Responsibilities	7
Food Allergy Disclaimer	8
Avoiding Cross-Contact	8
Your Resources	9
Specific Allergy Information	10
Our Commitment: How Can We Help You?	12
Faqs Frequently Asked Questions	13

FROM US *To You*

Welcome to NYU Eats! The health and safety of our guests is our highest priority at New York University and for NYU Eats. In support of our guests with food allergies and other dietary restrictions, we have created this guide for your reference.

Be aware that we handle and prepare egg, milk, wheat, shellfish, fish, soy, sesame, peanut and tree nut products, and other potential allergens in the food production areas of our facility.

We attempt to provide nutrition and ingredient information that is as complete as possible. Vendors may substitute ingredients without our knowledge and menu items are prepared in close proximity to other ingredients that may result in cross-contact with ingredients not listed, including allergens. Guests with food allergies or specific dietary concerns should always speak to an Allergen Champion who is the Executive Chef, Director or manager on staff for individualized assistance.

Also remember: Don't be Shy! Self Identify.

New York University
Registered Dietitian
nyu.eats.nutrition@nyu.edu

OUR *Philosophy*

NYU Eats believes that good nutrition is essential to good health. That's why we are committed to nourishing each and every student by providing them with healthy, nutritious foods every day.

NYU Eats supports students who have food allergies by providing information and knowledge that is necessary to make informed food choices in all of our dining locations.

We work together to provide reasonable arrangements so that students may participate in the college dining experience as much as possible. We recognize that students with food allergies already experience a more limited diet than those who do not have an allergy and are required to exert more time and effort in managing their diet than others. We take into account each individual student's personal dietary needs and make every effort to provide helpful information to those with food allergies.

Our goal is to provide students with the tools that they need to be active in the management of their food allergy or food-related medical condition within the dining locations. We want to provide a safe and supportive transition into college life.

HOW TO

Self-Identify

Student responsibilities when managing a food allergy in the dining locations:

1) Notify NYU Eats Dining team of your allergy(ies). Schedule a meeting with our Dietitian, Food Service Director and Executive Chef to develop a plan so you can navigate the dining halls. Do this by emailing nyu.eats.nutrition@nyu.edu.

2) Be proficient in the self-management of your food allergy(ies) including:

- Avoidance of foods to which you are allergic
- Recognition of symptoms of allergic reactions
- How and when to tell someone you might be having an allergy-related problem
- Knowledge of proper use of medications to treat an allergic reaction
- Carry emergency contact information with you at all times
- Review policies/procedures with NYU Eats and your physician should a reaction occur
- Register with NYU's Moses Center by emailing mosescsa@nyu.edu

3) Read the station signage, menus, and ingredient information, made available upon request or online at nyueats.com to be better informed.

4) When in doubt regarding ingredients in a particular food or dish, direct your questions to our **"Allergen Champion"**, who is also our Food Service Director, Assistant Director, or Executive Chef on duty. If you do not know who these individuals are, look for someone wearing the button pictured here or ask a cashier or another employee on duty to contact them.



5) Due to the nature of the residential dining halls and retail locations, if you have been prescribed an Epi-pen carry it with you at all times.

6) If you notice something that is problematic for your allergy, please notify an Allergen Champion so they can look into your concern.

7) If you have a question at any point, please ask an Allergen Champion. If we do not hear from you, we believe that you are successfully navigating the dining locations.

YOUR

Responsibilities

It's our goal to provide students who identify as having food allergies or intolerances with the necessary information so they may make confident food choices. It's pertinent for these students to help manage their food allergies or intolerances by doing the following to avoid cross-contact:

- You may ask a dining employee to change his/her gloves.
- You may ask a dining employee to use a new utensil, or a fresh pan at made-to-order stations.
- Take caution with deep-fried foods. Frying oil is reused before being changed. This can lead to cross contact because food fried in oil releases some of its protein, which is then absorbed by other foods fried in the same oil.(Examples include: fried chicken, fried fish, mozzarella sticks,nuggets, onion rings and French fries). Always ask to see the nutrition label of products not made in house, such as tater tots and veggie burgers, to scan for hidden ingredients.
- Take caution with bakery items. Any items prepared on-site have the potential to come into contact with other ingredients in the kitchen. Items prepared off-site are made in facilities that may also produce or prepare other allergen containing ingredients and may contain allergens.
- Students may request ingredients that are stored separately from items displayed at the station.

FOOD ALLERGY

Disclaimer

NYU Eats uses manufacturer-provided ingredient information, and we do not confirm the presence or lack of an allergen. We periodically review ingredients to verify that ingredient labeling is consistent with what is provided by the manufacturer. However, please be advised that ingredients listed may be subject to change without notification and that products prepared in our kitchen may have come into contact with common food allergens. Please direct any questions regarding an allergy or food ingredients to any of the Allergen Champions on duty. For questions you may also contact our Campus Dietitian by emailing **nyu.eats.nutrition@nyu.edu**

AVOIDING

Cross-Contact

Cross-contact occurs when one food comes into contact with another food and their proteins mix, creating the potential for an allergic reaction. We train and educate employees involved in the production process to change gloves and clean utensils between recipes to reduce cross-contact concerns. Always inform the Allergen Champion of your allergy or dietary restriction to assess the risk or possible cross-contact in the meal.

Each cook/front-line associate is also instructed to follow standardized recipes as written so as not to introduce any item to the recipe that is not on the recipe card. Frequent production audits are performed to assess recipe adherence and production processes and to stay informed of new products being purchased. It is not advised to ask an associate serving food if the dish is safe to eat. Always direct your questions to an Allergen Champion.

YOUR *Resources*

The following resources are available to help you manage your food allergy or allergies:

- 1) An individual meeting with the NYU Eats Dietitian, Director and Executive Chef to receive information and develop an individualized plan to help you navigate the residential dining facilities.
- 2) The Allergen Champions on duty are available in residential dining halls and retail locations to address questions/concerns and serve as important resources. When in a particular unit, please ask for a food service manager or email the Dietitian at : nyu.eats.nutrition@nyu.edu
- 3) Access to our Allergen Champion for ingredient consultation.
- 4) Introduction to the dining management team to give you direct access to individuals responsible for food preparation.
- 5) Online menus for each dining location at nyueats.com.
- 6) Manufacturer-provided entrée ingredient lists, provided upon request.
- 7) Signage located at each food station in our residential dining locations outlines nutrition information. Please visit nyueats.com to access full nutrition labels.
- 8) Nutritional information for internally produced retail food and nationally branded retail items is available online at nyueats.com. Nutrition information for purchased or pre-packaged retail items is available upon request. If ingredients for pre-packaged items are not listed on NYU Eats.com please email nyu.eats.nutrition@nyu.edu for ingredient information. Be cautious, as ingredients listed on NYUEats.com are subject to change. Always consult with an Allergen Champion.
- 9) Access to the NYU culinary team to provide package labels for all dry and cold food storage items. This ensures you can review ingredients personally to make the best decisions for your dietary needs. Please schedule advanced notice to establish the foods you wish to review and on what date/time. Schedule a session by emailing nyu.eats.nutrition@nyu.edu.
- 10) Access to individually packaged foods to replace bulk items that have a high likelihood of cross-contact (i.e., packets of cream cheese, jelly, and peanut butter). NYU Eats wants you to feel at home in our dining spaces. During your individual meeting with dining services, please provide a wish list of items that are your favorites so that we can try and ensure the availability of individually packaged items for you.
- 11) Dining staff are trained to change gloves at least every 30 minutes to minimize cross-contact concerns.

SPECIFIC

Allergy Information

Refer to the menus and ingredient information made available to you. We use manufacturer-provided information, and we do not confirm the presence or lack of an allergen.

NYU Eats periodically reviews ingredients to verify ingredient labeling is consistent with what is provided by the manufacturer. Ingredients listed may be subject to change without notification.

WHEAT/GLUTEN ALLERGIES

We offer a selection of deli meats and salad dressings that do not contain gluten. Gluten-free cereal is available daily, and gluten-free breads, bagels, wraps, pasta, pizza, and bakery items such as cookies and muffins items are available upon request. Be sure to check the ingredients of all food items you wish to consume. Look for the Avoiding Gluten icons on dishes that are prepared in house. We use the term “Avoiding Gluten” to identify dishes made without gluten containing ingredients. Since gluten can be airborne for 24 hours we cannot use the term gluten-free for items made in-house. If you have any questions, just ask our on-site Allergen Champions or email nyu.eats.nutrition@nyu.edu for more information from a registered dietitian.*

MILK ALLERGIES

A non-dairy milk option is available every day in residential dining facilities. However, milk and milk-based products are ingredients used in many of the menu items served. Items prepared with butter or margarine should also be avoided.

SOY ALLERGIES

Soybean oil is present in a large variety of products, most notably our cooking and frying oils. While studies have shown that highly refined soy oil is safe to consume for most with a soy allergy, if a medical professional has noted that you have a severe allergy, you should consider alternate options.

* Even foods commonly prepared without gluten-containing ingredients may not be ‘gluten-free.’ Our recipes are prepared in open kitchens, where cross-contact is possible and where ingredient substitutions are sometimes made. If you have celiac disease or a gluten sensitivity, please notify your on-site manager to request an individually prepared avoiding-gluten meal.

EGG ALLERGIES

Many of our baked goods and desserts contain eggs. However, desserts such as fruit crisps and gelatin parfaits do not contain eggs. Students are asked to take caution with all baked goods and are encouraged to check ingredient labels of items they wish to eat.

FISH/SHELLFISH ALLERGIES

Beyond entrées and mixed dishes that contain fish or shellfish as a main component, please use caution when selecting Asian dishes, where fish or shellfish may be included in sauces. Additionally, some gravies and barbeque sauces may contain Worcestershire sauce, which also contains fish. Students with fish or shellfish allergies are asked to check the menus and full ingredient list.

PEANUT ALLERGIES

We limit the use of peanut products in our recipes. Any items containing peanuts will have this noted in the name of the dish. Ice creams are manufactured in facilities that also process peanuts and tree nuts, and our coffee shops may have items with tree nuts and peanuts. Students with a peanut allergy are advised to take caution with bakery items. Peanut oil is not used as an ingredient in our recipes.

TREE NUT ALLERGIES

Tree nuts may be present in select dessert items. Ice creams are manufactured in facilities that also process peanuts and tree nuts, and our coffee shops may have items with tree nuts and peanuts. Students with a tree nut allergy are advised to take caution with bakery items and any menu items that contain pesto, coconut or coconut milk.

SESAME

Sesame is present in items like hummus, baba ganoush, breads, bagels, sushi, falafel, tempeh, veggie burgers, and dressings, to name a few. In accordance with the FASTER Act, food manufacturers are now required to label sesame on their products. As a result, some foods that we purchase that previously may not have contained sesame have been reformulated to include sesame. Students with a sesame allergy should always verify ingredients with Allergen Champions.

OUR COMMITMENT:

How Can We Help You?

Here at NYU, we've developed a plan with students who have special dietary needs to contact NYU Eats.

- 1) The student meets with our campus dietitian who works with them to review specific allergies, gather information on how they have managed the allergy up until now, and learn initial information about how to navigate the NYU Eats locations.
- 2) After the initial meeting, the NYU Eats Dietitian and the on-site Allergen Champions, who are also our Executive Chef, Director, and Assistant Director work together to customize a plan to accommodate the student's dietary needs. Individual menu development and specially prepared foods can be provided when the daily offerings do not meet an individual's dietary needs.
- 3) Students are encouraged to touch base with an Allergen Champion daily to ensure safety of meals and minimize the risk of cross-contact.
- 4) On-going evaluation occurs after these initial meetings. Our campus dietitian and on-site Allergen Champions will touch base with you throughout the semester. If questions arise or a student has concerns about the daily offerings, they are encouraged to reach out to the campus dietitian by emailing nyu.eats.nutrition@nyu.edu to resolve the issue.

FAQs

Frequently Asked Questions

1) Should I assume what the ingredients are in a menu item?

Never assume. Although there might be a common item on the line, don't assume you know the ingredients. We have different products based off our vendors' availability, so an ingredient we use today can potentially be a different brand from time to time. The safest and most reliable practice is to just ask every time you dine.

2) Who should I ask or talk to about a question on the menu?

Always ask the manager or chef. Our trained Allergen Champions will be able to ensure you are provided with accurate ingredient information. You can locate an Allergen Champion at each unit by asking one of the line associates to speak to a management professional to help you navigate our dining facilities.

3) What's the difference between "Gluten-Free" and "Avoiding Gluten"?

Avoiding Gluten means our products do not include any fresh or manufactured food that contains gluten. Gluten-Free means the food item contains less than 20 ppm of gluten, which can only be determined through laboratory testing. Since we prepare products in common kitchens with shared equipment, it is not possible that our products can maintain gluten-free status as established by the manufacturer.



NYU EATS